
budget approval

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Hi guys,

It is that magic time of year to approve the budget for the next year. And like so many previous years, you are having to approach it somewhat blindly and with hope as the legislature did not take the appropriate timely action to provide the new funding. Adequacy is a whole other discussion 😊

Since I received the tax proposal statement from the county and trying to match up the district rates to that document is not an easy process especially given what the legislature requirement to be sent out is not a good reflection of the real assessments. Again, another discussion. Bottom line, it is good to see the district able to reduce the rate per thousand (I think I am reading these crazy new documents correctly) but I'm sure the increased assessed values and the district's being able to reduce the management levy after two years of aggressive early retirement are the main factors.

However, when I was trying to compare the FY25 and 26 amounts to prior years on the proposed budget, I went back to the business office website to look for district ACFR(audits) or other financial reports and was very disappointed to see that all of these reports have been removed from the district website. There was a requirement for school districts to have financial reports on the website but maybe that rule has been changed that allows for the lack of documents. Since there were no audit reports on the website, I went to the State Auditor website to search for the districts audits but do not find anything for fy23 and FY24. That is pretty concerning to see that noncompliance for the completion of an external audit within 9 months of the completion of the fiscal year. In addition, the bond covenants for the various GO and SAVE bonds had a requirement for audited financial statements within 210 days of the end of the fiscal year. Again, pretty concerning that these covenants may not be adhered to and the possible impact on the district bonds. (FYI, there are several other tabs on the business service pages of the district website with no information including updated student fees and the affiliate handbook and purchasing requirements)

Again, thanks for the work on the budget and tax rates and hopefully the completion and posting of financial reports will be updated very soon.

Thanks and have a good weekend,
Leslie